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Wound treatment apparatuses and methods with negative pressure source integrated into wound dressing

Abstract

Disclosed embodiments relate to apparatuses and methods for wound treatment. In some embodiments, a negative pressure source is incorporated into a wound dressing apparatus so that the wound dressing and the negative pressure source are part of an integral or integrated wound dressing structure that applies the wound dressing and the negative pressure source simultaneously to a patient's wound. The negative pressure source and/or electronic components may be positioned between a wound contact layer and a cover layer of the wound dressing. The negative pressure source and/or electronic components may be separated and/or partitioned from an absorbent area of the dressing. A switch may be integrated with the wound dressing to control operation of the wound dressing apparatus. A connector may be direct air from an outlet of the negative pressure source to the environment. A non-return valve may inhibit back flow of air into the wound dressing.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a divisional of U.S. application Ser. No. 16/082,884, filed Sep. 6, 2018, which is a U.S. national stage application of International Patent Application No. PCT/EP2017/055225, filed on Mar. 6, 2017, which claims priority to U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/304,790, filed Mar. 7, 2016, U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/305,926, filed Mar. 9, 2016, U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/304,910, filed Mar. 7, 2016, and U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/327,537, filed Apr. 26, 2016, the entireties of each of which are hereby incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND

Technical Field

(1) Embodiments described herein relate to apparatuses, systems, and methods the treatment of wounds, for example using dressings in combination with negative pressure wound therapy.

Description of the Related Art

(2) Prior art dressings for use in negative pressure have included a negative pressure source located in a remote location from the wound dressing. Further, when used, wound exudate may soak into the dressing, and the moisture from the wound has made it difficult to incorporate electronic components into the dressing.

SUMMARY

(3) Embodiments of the present disclosure relate to apparatuses and methods for wound treatment. Some of the wound treatment apparatuses described herein comprise a negative pressure source or a pump system for providing negative pressure to a wound. Wound treatment apparatuses may also comprise wound dressings that may be used in combination with the negative pressure sources and pump assemblies described herein. In some embodiments, a negative pressure source is incorporated into a wound dressing apparatus so that the wound dressing and the negative pressure source are part of an integral or integrated wound dressing structure that applies the wound dressing and the negative pressure source simultaneously to a patient's wound. The negative pressure source and/or electronic components may be positioned between a wound contact layer and a cover layer of the wound dressing. The negative pressure source and/or electronic components may be separated and/or partitioned from an absorbent area of the dressing. A switch may be integrated with the wound dressing to control operation of the wound dressing apparatus. A connector may be direct air from an outlet of the negative pressure source to the environment. A non-return valve may inhibit back flow of air into the wound dressing. These and other embodiments as described herein are directed to overcoming particular challenges involved with incorporating a negative pressure source and/or electronic components into a wound dressing.

(4) In some aspects, a wound dressing apparatus comprises a wound contact layer configured to be positioned in contact with a wound, a first area over the wound contact layer comprises a lower spacer layer and an absorbent layer, a second area over the wound contact layer comprising a plurality of spacer layers and a negative pressure source and/or electronic components positioned within or between the plurality of spacer layers, wherein the first area is positioned adjacent to the second area and separated by a partition, an upper spacer layer configured to cover the first area

and the second area and to allow air to be communicated between the first area and second area around the partition, and a cover layer configured to cover and form a seal over the wound contact layer, the upper spacer layer, the first area, and the second area.

(5) The apparatus of the preceding paragraph may also include any combination of the following features described in this paragraph, among others described herein. The plurality of spacer layers in the second area can include a third spacer layer beneath the negative pressure source and/or electronic components and a fourth spacer layer positioned above the negative pressure source and/or electronic components, wherein the fourth spacer layer comprises one or more cutouts or recesses configured to receive the negative pressure source and/or electronic components. The partition can include a non-porous dam. The apparatus can comprise one or more user interface components configured to allow a user to operate the negative pressure source and/or electronic components.

(6) In some aspects, a wound dressing apparatus can comprise a wound dressing configured to be positioned over a wound site, a negative pressure source disposed on or positioned within the wound dressing, and a switch integrated with the wound dressing configured to control operation of the wound dressing apparatus.

(7) The apparatus of the preceding paragraph may also include any combination of the following features described in this paragraph, among others described herein. The switch can be at least one of positioned within, disposed on, or embedded in the wound dressing. The wound dressing can comprise a wound dressing body and a wound dressing border, the wound dressing border extending along at least of a portion of a perimeter defined around the wound dressing body. The switch can be integrated with the wound dressing body or the wound dressing border. The switch can be at least one of positioned within, disposed on, or embedded in the wound dressing body or the wound dressing border. The wound dressing body and the wound dressing border can comprise a top layer and a bottom layer, the top layer comprising a cover layer and the bottom layer comprising a wound contact layer, the switch being integrated with the wound dressing proximally adjacent at least one of the top layer and the bottom layer. The wound dressing body or the wound dressing border can comprise a flexiboard layer beneath the switch to dissipate and/or inhibit the transfer of a compression force to the wound site when the switch is actuated. The switch can be configured to be actuated by pressing the switch in a first direction with a finger. The wound dressing can comprise a tab that extends from the wound dressing border, the switch being integrated with the tab. The switch can be at least one of positioned within, disposed on, or embedded in the tab. The tab can be configured to be lifted by a user so that the switch can be actuated by the user by applying force to the switch in two opposing directions on opposite or different sides of the tab. The wound dressing can comprise a joint between the tab and the wound dressing border to facilitate movement of the tab without applying force to the wound dressing body or the wound dressing border, the tab being configured to rotate about the joint when a user moves the tab. The apparatus can include one or more indicators configured to indicate one or more statuses of the wound dressing apparatus. The one or more indicators can comprise one or more visual indicators. The one or more visual indicators can comprise one or more light emitting diodes (LEDs). The one or more indicators can be configured to indicate a battery level of the wound dressing apparatus. The one or more indicators can extend around the switch. The one or more indicators can circumferentially extend around the switch. The switch can be positioned in a sub-flush position relative to the one or more indicators to inhibit accidental or inadvertent actuation of the switch. The switch can be selectively operable by a user to control operation of the negative pressure source. The switch can be selectively operable by a user to turn on and turn off the negative pressure source. The switch can be electrically connected to the negative pressure source. The negative pressure source can be a micro pump.

(8) In some aspects, a wound dressing apparatus can comprise a wound dressing configured to be positioned over a wound site, a negative pressure source disposed on or positioned within the

wound dressing, the negative pressure source comprising an inlet and an outlet, the negative pressure source being configured to apply negative pressure to the wound site via the inlet and being further configured to remove air from the wound dressing via the outlet, and a connector comprising first and second ends and a flow path therebetween, wherein the first end is in fluid communication with the outlet and the second end is open to an environment outside the wound dressing, wherein a portion of the flow path extends through an opening defined in the wound dressing, the flow path being configured to direct air from the outlet to the environment.

(9) The apparatus of the preceding paragraph may also include any combination of the following features described in this paragraph, among others described herein. The opening in the wound dressing can be defined on a top layer of the wound dressing. The top layer can comprise a moisture vapor permeable film. The opening in the wound dressing can be defined between a top layer and a bottom layer of the wound dressing. The opening in the wound dressing can be defined through an edge of the wound dressing between a top layer and a bottom layer of the wound dressing. The top layer can comprise a moisture vapor permeable film and the bottom layer comprises a wound contact layer. The connector can comprise a spacer that extends between a first and second portion of the connector, the spacer being configured to resist collapse of the connector when the connector is compressed. The first and second portions of the connector can comprise the first and second ends of the connector. The spacer can be enveloped in a film to form a gas tight seal with the wound dressing. The spacer can comprise a length of 3D fabric material. The film can be a plastic film. The film can be Versapore film having a pore size diameter of about 2 μm . The connector can form a gas tight seal with the wound dressing. The connector can form a gas tight seal with the outlet of the negative pressure source. The connector can be configured to resist collapse, thereby inhibiting occlusion of the connector when the wound dressing is subjected to compressive forces. The connector can be configured to inhibit the ingress of water, foreign bodies, dirt, or bacteria through the opening in the wound dressing. The wound dressing apparatus further can comprise a tube interposed between the outlet and the connector, the tube being coupled to the outlet and the connector. The tube can be configured to extend the connector such that the connector is positioned outside of the wound dressing after the tube passes through the opening in the wound dressing.

(10) In some aspects, a wound dressing apparatus can comprise a wound dressing configured to be positioned over a wound site, a negative pressure source disposed on or positioned within the wound dressing, the negative pressure source comprising an inlet and an outlet and being operable to apply negative pressure to the wound site, and a non-return valve in fluid communication with the outlet, the non-return valve being configured to inhibit back flow of air into the wound dressing.

(11) The apparatus of the preceding paragraph may also include any combination of the following features described in this paragraph, among others described herein. The non-return valve can be configured to inhibit back flow of air into the wound dressing through the outlet. The non-return valve can be connected to the outlet. The non-return valve can comprise a first end in fluidic communication with the outlet and a second end in fluid communication with an exhaust component, the exhaust component being configured to direct air from the outlet to the environment. The first end of the non-return valve can be connected to the outlet and the second end of the non-return valve is connected to the exhaust component. The non-return valve is at least partially disposed in the outlet. The apparatus can include an exhaust system having first and second ends, wherein the exhaust system is interposed between the outlet and the non-return valve such that the first end is connected to the outlet and the second end is connected to the non-return valve. The apparatus can include an exhaust system, wherein the non-return valve is at least partially integrated with the exhaust system. The non-return valve can be at least partially integrated with the exhaust system at an end of the exhaust system. The non-return valve can be integrated with the wound dressing. The non-return valve can be positioned within and/or

embedded in the wound dressing. The non-return valve can comprise a size configured to fit within the wound dressing. The non-return valve can have a height that is less than a thickness of the wound dressing. The non-return valve can have a low cracking pressure and a low resistance to out flow. The non-return valve can have a cracking pressure of less than 500 Pa for a nominal flow rate of about 1 mL/min through the apparatus. The non-return valve can have an out flow resistance of less than 30 mL/min as measured with a nominally fixed vacuum of 10.7 kPa below atmosphere. The non-return valve can provide a resistance to air flowing out of the wound dressing apparatus of less than 100 mL/min as measured with a nominally fixed vacuum of 10.7 kPa below atmosphere. The negative pressure source and the non-return valve together can allow air to leak into the wound dressing apparatus via the outlet at a negligible rate of less than 2.0 mL/min. The non-return valve can be a mechanical valve that is self-activated. The non-return valve can comprise a duckbill valve. The non-return valve can comprise a reed valve. The reed valve can comprise a 75 micron thick polyester reed valve. The non-return valve can comprise a cavity with an inlet port and an outlet port and a reed at least partially disposed in the cavity. The non-return valve can comprise a crescent shape. The crescent shape can be defined by a housing having a first curved surface that intersects a second surface. The second surface can be flat. The second surface can be curved, the second surface can have a radius of curvature that is greater than a radius of curvature of the first curved surface. The second surface can be semi-rigid or flexible such that it is configured to conform to a surface of the wound site. The non-return valve can comprise a crescent shape, wherein the reed can comprise a rectangular shape with circular ends. The non-return valve can comprise a crescent shape, wherein the reed can include a curved portion. The negative pressure source can be a micro pump. The apparatus can include a controller configured to control the operation of the micro pump to apply negative pressure to the wound site.

(12) Any of the features, components, or details of any of the arrangements or embodiments disclosed in this application, including without limitation any of the pump embodiments and any of the negative pressure wound therapy embodiments disclosed below, are interchangeably combinable with any other features, components, or details of any of the arrangements or embodiments disclosed herein to form new arrangements and embodiments.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) Embodiments of the present disclosure will now be described hereinafter, by way of example only, with reference to the accompanying drawings in which:
- (2) FIG. 1 illustrates an embodiment of a topical negative pressure wound treatment apparatus comprising a wound dressing in combination with a pump;
- (3) FIG. 2 illustrates an embodiment of a source of negative pressure and battery integrated on top of a dressing layer;
- (4) FIG. 3 illustrates an embodiment of layers of a wound dressing with integrated pump and electronic components;
- (5) FIG. 4 illustrates an embodiment of a cross-section of an integrated wound dressing;
- (6) FIG. 5 illustrates an embodiment of a cross-section of an integrated wound dressing with ultrasonic oscillation;
- (7) FIGS. 6A-6D illustrates embodiments of a pump pouch or pockets according to some embodiments;
- (8) FIG. 7 illustrates an embodiment of a pressure fuse that can be used to discontinue operation of the pump if the pressure exceeds an acceptable (or safe) threshold pressure;
- (9) FIG. 8 illustrates an embodiment of an integrated wound dressing with the pump and electronics package incorporated within the dressing;

(10) FIGS. 9A-9B illustrate another embodiment of an integrated wound dressing;

(11) FIG. 10 illustrates a close up view of one end of an embodiment of an integrated wound dressing;

(12) FIG. 11A shows a top view of an embodiment of a wound dressing where the pump and associated components are visible;

(13) FIG. 11B shows a bottom view of an embodiment of a wound dressing where recesses for the pump and associated components are visible;

(14) FIGS. 12A-12B illustrate an embodiment of a wound dressing incorporating the source of negative pressure and/or other electronic components within the wound dressing;

(15) FIG. 13A illustrates an embodiment of a wound dressing with the pump and/or other electronics positioned away from the wound site;

(16) FIG. 13B illustrates an embodiment of layers of a wound dressing with the pump and electronic components offset from the absorbent area of the dressing;

(17) FIG. 14 illustrates a side cross-sectional view of an embodiment of a wound dressing with the pump and electronic components offset from the absorbent area of the dressing positioned over the wound;

(18) FIGS. 15-27 show embodiments of the wound dressing with the electronic components offset from the absorbent material of the dressing;

(19) FIG. 28A illustrates a side cross-sectional view of an embodiment of a wound dressing system;

(20) FIGS. 28B-28C illustrate a perspective view of an embodiment of a wound dressing system with a switch embedded into a wound dressing border;

(21) FIGS. 29A and 29B illustrate two views of a switch integrated with a wound dressing;

(22) FIGS. 30C-30E show embodiments of wound dressings with a switch integrated into the wound dressing border;

(23) FIGS. 30C-3E show embodiments of wound dressings with a switch integrated into the wound dressing border;

(24) FIG. 31A is a top view of an embodiment of an exhaust system coupled to an outlet of a pump;

(25) FIG. 31B is a perspective view of an embodiment of the exhaust system coupled to an outlet of a pump;

(26) FIGS. 32A and 32B illustrate an embodiment of a wound dressing system with components of the wound dressing system;

(27) FIG. 33A illustrates an embodiment of a connector and an extension conduit for a wound dressing system;

(28) FIG. 33B illustrates a perspective exploded view of an embodiment of the exhaust system of a wound dressing system;

(29) FIG. 33C is a schematic side view of an embodiment of an end of an exhaust system between a top layer and a bottom layer of the wound dressing;

(30) FIGS. 34A-34D illustrate embodiments of various views of duckbill non-return valves;

(31) FIGS. 35A-35C illustrate various views of embodiments of various reed valves coupled to a pump outlet;

(32) FIGS. 36A-36C illustrate various views of embodiments of a non-return valve having a crescent shape for integration into a wound dressing;

(33) FIG. 37 illustrates an embodiment of a crescent shaped non-return valve positioned superficially above an exhaust system and a wound dressing;

(34) FIGS. 38A-38E illustrate various positions of an embodiment of a non-return valve in relation to a pump and an exhaust system; and

(35) FIGS. 39A-39B illustrate two positions of an embodiment of a crescent-shaped non-return valve in relation to an exhaust system.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(36) Embodiments disclosed herein relate to apparatuses and methods of treating a wound with reduced pressure, including a source of negative pressure and wound dressing components and apparatuses. The apparatuses and components comprising the wound overlay and packing materials, if any, are sometimes collectively referred to herein as dressings.

(37) It will be appreciated that throughout this specification reference is made to a wound. It is to be understood that the term wound is to be broadly construed and encompasses open and closed wounds in which skin is torn, cut or punctured or where trauma causes a contusion, or any other superficial or other conditions or imperfections on the skin of a patient or otherwise that benefit from reduced pressure treatment. A wound is thus broadly defined as any damaged region of tissue where fluid may or may not be produced. Examples of such wounds include, but are not limited to, abdominal wounds or other large or incisional wounds, either as a result of surgery, trauma, sterniotomies, fasciotomies, or other conditions, dehiscent wounds, acute wounds, chronic wounds, subacute and dehiscent wounds, traumatic wounds, flaps and skin grafts, lacerations, abrasions, contusions, burns, diabetic ulcers, pressure ulcers, stoma, surgical wounds, trauma and venous ulcers or the like.

(38) It will be understood that embodiments of the present disclosure are generally applicable to use in topical negative pressure (“TNP”) therapy systems. Briefly, negative pressure wound therapy assists in the closure and healing of many forms of “hard to heal” wounds by reducing tissue oedema; encouraging blood flow and granular tissue formation; removing excess exudate and may reduce bacterial load (and thus infection risk). In addition, the therapy allows for less disturbance of a wound leading to more rapid healing. TNP therapy systems may also assist on the healing of surgically closed wounds by removing fluid and by helping to stabilize the tissue in the apposed position of closure. A further beneficial use of TNP therapy can be found in grafts and flaps where removal of excess fluid is important and close proximity of the graft to tissue is required in order to ensure tissue viability.

(39) As is used herein, reduced or negative pressure levels, such as $-X$ mmHg, represent pressure levels relative to normal ambient atmospheric pressure, which can correspond to 760 mmHg (or 1 atm, 29.93 inHg, 101.325 kPa, 14.696 psi, etc.). Accordingly, a negative pressure value of $-X$ mmHg reflects absolute pressure that is X mmHg below 760 mmHg or, in other words, an absolute pressure of $(760-X)$ mmHg. In addition, negative pressure that is “less” or “smaller” than X mmHg corresponds to pressure that is closer to atmospheric pressure (e.g., 31 40 mmHg is less than -60 mmHg). Negative pressure that is “more” or “greater” than $-X$ mmHg corresponds to pressure that is further from atmospheric pressure (e.g., -80 mmHg is more than -60 mmHg). In some embodiments, local ambient atmospheric pressure is used as a reference point, and such local atmospheric pressure may not necessarily be, for example, 760 mmHg.

(40) The negative pressure range for some embodiments of the present disclosure can be approximately -80 mmHg, or between about -20 mmHg and 31 200 mmHg. Note that these pressures are relative to normal ambient atmospheric pressure, which can be 760 mmHg. Thus, -200 mmHg would be about 560 mmHg in practical terms. In some embodiments, the pressure range can be between about -40 mmHg and -150 mmHg. Alternatively, a pressure range of up to -75 mmHg, up to -80 mmHg or over -80 mmHg can be used. Also in other embodiments a pressure range of below -75 mmHg can be used. Alternatively, a pressure range of over approximately -100 mmHg, or even -150 mmHg, can be supplied by the negative pressure apparatus.

(41) In some embodiments of wound closure devices described herein, increased wound contraction can lead to increased tissue expansion in the surrounding wound tissue. This effect may be increased by varying the force applied to the tissue, for example by varying the negative pressure applied to the wound over time, possibly in conjunction with increased tensile forces applied to the wound via embodiments of the wound closure devices. In some embodiments, negative pressure may be varied over time for example using a sinusoidal wave, square wave,

and/or in synchronization with one or more patient physiological indices (e.g., heartbeat). Examples of such applications where additional disclosure relating to the preceding may be found include U.S. Pat. No. 8,235,955, titled "Wound treatment apparatus and method," issued on Aug. 7, 2012; and U.S. Pat. No. 7,753,894, titled "Wound cleansing apparatus with stress," issued Jul. 13, 2010. The disclosures of both of these patents are hereby incorporated by reference in their entirety. (42) International Application PCT/GB2012/000587, titled "WOUND DRESSING AND METHOD OF TREATMENT" and filed on Jul. 12, 2012, and published as WO 2013/007973 A2 on Jan. 17, 2013, is an application, hereby incorporated and considered to be part of this specification, that is directed to embodiments, methods of manufacture, and wound dressing components and wound treatment apparatuses that may be used in combination or in addition to the embodiments described herein. Additionally, embodiments of the wound dressings, wound treatment apparatuses and methods described herein may also be used in combination or in addition to those described in U.S. Provisional Application No. 61/650,904, filed May 23, 2012, titled "APPARATUSES AND METHODS FOR NEGATIVE PRESSURE WOUND THERAPY," International Application No. PCT/IB2013/001469, filed May 22, 2013, titled "APPARATUSES AND METHODS FOR NEGATIVE PRESSURE WOUND THERAPY," and published as WO 2013/175306 on Nov. 28, 2013, U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/418,874, filed Jan. 30, 2015, published as U.S. Publication No. 2015/0216733, published Aug. 6, 2015, titled "WOUND DRESSING AND METHOD OF TREATMENT," U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/418,908, filed Jan. 30, 2015, published as U.S. Publication No. 2015/0190286, published Jul. 9, 2015, titled "WOUND DRESSING AND METHOD OF TREATMENT," U.S. patent application Ser. No. 14/658,068, filed Mar. 13, 2015, U.S. Application No. 2015/0182677, published Jul. 2, 2015, titled "WOUND DRESSING AND METHOD OF TREATMENT," the disclosures of which are hereby incorporated by reference in their entireties. Embodiments of the wound dressings, wound treatment apparatuses and methods described herein may also be used in combination or in addition to those described in U.S. patent application Ser. No. 13/092,042, filed Apr. 21 2011, published as US2011/0282309, titled "WOUND DRESSING AND METHOD OF USE," and which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety, including further details relating to embodiments of wound dressings, the wound dressing components and principles, and the materials used for the wound dressings.

(43) FIG. 1 illustrates an embodiment of a TNP wound treatment comprising a wound dressing **100** in combination with a pump **108**. As stated above, the wound dressing **100** can be any wound dressing embodiment disclosed herein including without limitation dressing embodiment **100** or have any combination of features of any number of wound dressing embodiments disclosed herein. Here, the dressing **100** may be placed over a wound, and a conduit **120** may then be connected to the port **150**, although in some embodiments the dressing **100** may be provided with at least a portion of the conduit **120** preattached to the port **150**. Preferably, the dressing **100** is provided as a single article with all wound dressing elements (including the port **150**) pre-attached and integrated into a single unit. The wound dressing **100** may then be connected, via the conduit **120**, to a source of negative pressure such as the pump **108**. The pump **108** can be miniaturized and portable, although larger conventional pumps may also be used with the dressing **100**. In some embodiments, the pump **108** may be attached or mounted onto or adjacent the dressing **100**. A connector **121** may also be provided so as to permit the conduit **120** leading to the wound dressing **100** to be disconnected from the pump, which may be useful for example during dressing changes.

(44) In some embodiments, a source of negative pressure (such as a pump) and some or all other components of the TNP system, such as power source(s), sensor(s), connector(s), user interface component(s) (such as button(s), switch(es), speaker(s), screen(s), etc.) and the like, can be integral with the wound dressing. As is illustrated in FIG. 2, the source of negative pressure and battery can be included within the integrated dressing **200**. Although FIG. 2 illustrates the source of negative pressure and battery **210** placed on top of the dressing layer **240** (such as an absorbent layer), the

source of negative pressure and one or more components can be incorporated into the dressing differently. The source of negative pressure and the one or more components need not all be incorporated into the dressing in the same manner. For example, a pressure sensor can be positioned below (or closer to the wound) the layer **240** while the source of negative pressure can be positioned on top of the layer **240**. FIGS. **6A-6D** illustrate alternative arrangements for incorporating the negative pressure source and the one or more components into the dressing. The integrated dressing **200** illustrated in FIG. **2** includes a cover layer **230** that includes for securing the dressing to skin surrounding the wound. The cover layer **230** can be formed of substantially fluid impermeable material, such as film. The cover layer can include an adhesive for securing the dressing to the surrounding skin or wound contact layer.

(45) In some embodiments, the dressing can include the power source and other components, such as electronics, on and/or incorporated into the dressing and can utilize a wound contact layer and a first spacer layer within the dressing. The wound contact layer can be configured to be in contact with the wound. The wound contact layer can include an adhesive on the patient facing side for securing the dressing to the surrounding skin or on the top side for securing the wound contact layer to a cover layer or other layer of the dressing. In operation, the wound contact layer can be configured to provide unidirectional flow so as to facilitate removal of exudate from the wound while blocking or substantially preventing exudate from returning to the wound. The first spacer layer assists in distributing negative pressure over the wound site and facilitating transport of wound exudate and fluids into the wound dressing. Further, an absorbent layer (such as layer **240**) for absorbing and retaining exudate aspirated from the wound can be utilized. In some embodiments, the absorbent includes a shaped form of a superabsorber layer with recesses or compartments for the pump, electronics, and accompanying components. These layers can be covered with one layer of a film or cover layer (or a first cover layer). The first cover layer can include a filter set that can be positioned within one of the recesses. The filter can be configured to align with one of the at least one recesses of the absorbent layer, and the filter can include hydrophobic material to protect the pump and/or other components from liquid exudates. The filter can block fluids while permitting gases to pass through. The pump, electronics, switch and battery can be positioned on top of the first cover layer. Another section of spacer, a second spacer, can be positioned above and/or surrounding the pump. In some embodiments, the second spacer can be smaller than the first spacer used above the wound contact layer. A section of top film or cover layer (or a second cover layer) is positioned over the top of the second spacer with a second filter associated with or positioned within the second cover layer. In some embodiments, the first and second cover layer can be made of the same material. In some embodiments, the first and second cover layers can be made of different material.

(46) A second filter can be alternative or additionally used. For example, filter **220** can be constructed from antibacterial and/or antimicrobial materials so that the pump can exhaust gases into the atmosphere. Filter **220** can also help to reduce noise produced by the pump.

(47) In certain embodiments, the first and second cover layers include a moisture vapor permeable material that protects the pump and electronic components from liquid exudate removed from the wound and other liquids, while allowing gases through. The pump and electronics can be pouched between the fluid impermeable membranes or cover layers with the only input and output being a filter on each side of the pump. The membranes and filter can protect the electronics from liquid from both sides. In some embodiments, the dressing and integrated electronics pouch can be used in the shower and/or can be in contact with liquid without impeding the operation of the pump and dressing.

(48) In some embodiments, in addition to or instead of one or more batteries, one or more alternative energy generators (such as RF energy harvester, thermal energy harvester, and the like) can be included into the pump to provide an alternative to traditional power sources. Examples of energy harvesters are described in U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/097,272, filed on Dec. 29,

2014 and U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/172,704, filed on Jun. 8, 2015, and titled "Negative Pressure Wound Therapy Apparatus and Methods for Operating the Apparatus," the disclosures of which are incorporated by reference in their entireties.

(49) FIG. 3 illustrates the layers of a wound dressing **300** with integrated pump and electronic components, such as a controller configured to control the pump, according to some embodiments. The dressing layer **240** includes a wound contact layer **310**, a spacer layer **311**, and an absorbent layer **312**. In some embodiments, the spacer layer **311** can be formed at least partially from a three dimensional (3D) fabric. In certain embodiments, a superabsorbent material can be used in the absorbent layer **312**. The absorbent layer **312** can include one or more recesses **318** (and **318a**) within the layer to accommodate placement of the pump, electronics, and/or power source. A moisture vapor permeable top film or first cover layer **313** is positioned above the absorbent layer **312**. The cover layer **313** can include a filter **320**. The filter can be positioned in line with and above a recess **318a** in the absorbent layer **212**.

(50) A pump **316**, electronics package **315**, and power source **314** (such as a battery) can be positioned above the cover layer **313** as shown in FIG. 3. The pump **316**, electronics package **315**, and power source **314** can be positioned on top of the cover layer **313** and at least partially depressed into the corresponding recesses **318** (and **318a**) in the absorbent layer **312**. For example, the pump **316** can be at least partially depressed in the recess **318a**. A packing layer **317** can be positioned above and/or surrounding the pump **316**, electronics package **315**, and power source **314**. The packing layer **317** can be formed from spacer material and/or absorbent material. The packing layer **317** can include 3D spacer. In some embodiments, the packing layer **317** additionally or alternatively can include a superabsorbent material. A second moisture vapor permeable top film or second cover layer **319** can be positioned over and seal the packing layer **317**, pump **316**, electronics package **315**, and power source **314**. The second cover layer **319** can also include a second filter **220**.

(51) In some embodiments, the operation of the pump can vary depending on the environmental humidity level. It can be advantageous to provide mechanisms to drive moisture out of the dressing or otherwise limit or control the humidity of the dressing. In some embodiments, a chamber generated by the layers above the pump can be used to act as a pressurized sink for gases (such as gases exhausted by the pump), thereby increasing the relative humidity (or RH) and delta RH across the outer membrane, which in turn can increase the rate of evaporation.

(52) FIG. 4 illustrates a cross-section of an integrated wound dressing **400** showing the various layers according to some embodiments. The dressing **400** includes three filters **420**, **421**, **422**. First filter **422** can be provided in the first wound contact layer below the pump and electronic components similar to the first filter **320** in the first cover layer **313** as described with reference to FIG. 3. The dressing **400** can include a second filter **421** positioned above a pump **416** as is shown in FIG. 4. In operation, the pump **416** inflates chamber **430** with gases removed from the wound. After inflation, chamber **430** can provide both bolstering and cushioning of the dressing **400**. As shown in FIG. 4, an optional superabsorber **432** can be included in the chamber **430** above a moisture vapor permeable film or cover layer **434** and below the moisture vapor permeable top film or second cover layer **419**. In such embodiments, the superabsorber **432** can draw fluid through the cover layer **434**, and the increased pressure in chamber **430** can facilitate an increased evaporation to atmosphere. A third filter **420** can be positioned within or adjacent to the second moisture vapor permeable top film or second cover layer **419**. Filter **420** can function similar to filter **220** illustrated in FIG. 2.

(53) In some embodiments, the pump can include a piezoelectric transducer that causes negative pressure to be supplied to the wound. In certain embodiments, a secondary device (such as a secondary piezoelectric device) can be used to generate atomisation of the fluid in the dressing, either accelerating evaporation of the water portion of the wound fluid or firing it through the moisture vapor permeable (MVP) top film where it can then evaporate. This can reduce or

eliminate the effect of environmental humidity on the capability of the dressing to evaporate water. (54) FIG. 5 illustrates a cross-section of an integrated wound dressing **500** according to some embodiments. In the illustrated dressing **500**, a top layer or second cover layer **519** is optional. In some embodiments, one or more ultrasonic oscillators **501** can be used to atomize water from the superabsorber and/or absorbent layer **512** or from between the top film or first cover layer **513** and the optional top film or second cover layer **519**. In some embodiments, oscillation can be provided by a separate component such as a pump **516**. In such embodiments, the one or more ultrasonic oscillators **501** would not be included in the dressing. The dressing **500** includes a wound contact layer **510** and a spacer layer **511**.

(55) In some embodiments, the electronics and/or associated components can be contained in single or multiple sealed pockets or pouches. The pockets or pouches can include the pump, electronics, and/or power source(s) (such as batteries) with or without a spacer layer padding. The packets may be designed to allow easy separation of the electronics from the dressing for disposal.

(56) FIGS. 6A-6D illustrates embodiments of a pump pouch or pockets according to some embodiments. FIG. 6A illustrates an integrated wound dressing in which a pump **616** is placed on top of an absorbent layer. Electronics and power source(s) can be similarly placed. FIG. 6B illustrates an integrated wound dressing in which a pump **616** is positioned above the first cover layer **613** in a recess of the absorbent layer **612**. This positioning is similar to that illustrated in FIG. 3. Electronics and power source(s) can be similarly placed.

(57) FIGS. 6C-6D illustrate embodiments of wound dressings comprising a pump and electronics package **650**. The package **650** can also include power source(s). The pump and electronics package **650** can be positioned in the dressing as described with reference to FIG. 3. In other embodiments, the pump and electronics packages **650** can be positioned in alternative positions than what is described with reference to FIG. 3. For example, as depicted in FIG. 6C, the dressing can comprise a wound contact layer **610**, a spacer layer **611**, a moisture vapor permeable film or first cover layer **613** positioned above the contact layer **610** and spacer layer **611**. The pump and electronics package **650** can be positioned above the first cover layer **613**. Additionally, the absorbent layer **622** can be positioned above the first cover layer **613** and adjacent to the pump and electronics package **650**. A second cover layer **619** can be positioned above the absorbent layer **622** and can seal at the perimeter of the second cover layer **619** to the wound contact layer **610** at the perimeter of the wound contact layer **610**. Filter **620** can be located adjacent to the pump and electronics package **650**. The filter **620** can be a hydrophobic filter configured to protect the pump and electronics package from exposure to fluid. Second filter **621** can be located on the second cover layer **619**. The second filter can be located at a position adjacent to an outlet or exhaust of the pump system. Additionally or alternatively, the exhaust of the pump can be gaseously connected to the filter **621** positioned proximate to the exhaust. The gaseous connection can include one or more conduits and/or chambers.

(58) FIG. 6D illustrates an embodiment of a wound dressing with pump and electronics package **650** positioned within the dressing. The dressing can include a wound contact layer **610** and spacer layer **611**. A moisture vapor permeable film or first cover layer **613** can be positioned above the wound contact layer **610** and the spacer layer **611**. The pump and electronics package **650** can be positioned above the first cover layer **613**. An absorbent layer **622** can be provided above the pump or electronics package **650**. A filter **620** can be provided between the pump and electronics package **650** and the absorbent layer **622** as shown in FIG. 6D. The filter **620** can protect the pump and electronics package **650** from exposure to fluid. An additional filter or second filter **621** can be provided on a second moisture vapor permeable film or second cover layer **619**. The filter **621** can be located at a position adjacent to an outlet or exhaust of the pump system or proximate to the exhaust (and connected to the exhaust via one or more conduits and/or chambers). For example, as is illustrated, a chamber **630** can gaseously connect the pump exhaust and the filter **621**. In some embodiments, the chamber **630** can function similar to the chamber **430** of FIG. 4. Additionally or

alternatively, the chamber **630** can be configured as a silencer to mute noise produced by the pump. The second cover layer **619** can be positioned above the absorbent layer **622** and can seal at the perimeter of the second cover layer **619** to the wound contact layer **610** at the perimeter of the wound contact layer **610**.

(59) In some embodiments, a circumference port can be used to bring fluid to the uppermost spacer layer first before being drawn down into the superabsorbent layer and pump. In some embodiments, a full circumference port or multiple circumferential ports can be used. The circumference ports can be used at the perimeter of the wound dressing. This can make the fluid behaviour independent of the direction the dressing is applied in. Without this feature, the capacity can be lower if the port is positioned at the bottom portion of the applied dressing.

(60) In some embodiments, the whole pump pouch can be generated as a specific layer that can be brought into the factory as a reel and/or folded raw material, allowing the manufacture of a full system using the machinery used to manufacture the layers of a wound dressing. The pump and other components can be placed into their respective compartments in the dressing.

(61) In some embodiments, one or more of the following pump additions can be added to the wound dressing with an integrated pump. The pressure sensor can be added onto a substrate of the pump (for example, ceramic substrate). A pressure fuse can be utilized on the pump substrate to discontinue operation of the pump if the pressure generated exceeds an acceptable threshold. Additionally, the pump can be designed for specific pressures. The pump can be designed to disable provision of negative pressure if fluid enters the pump itself.

(62) FIG. 7 illustrates a pressure fuse that can be used to discontinue operation of the pump if the pressure exceeds an acceptable (or safe) threshold pressure according to some embodiments. As illustrated in FIG. 7, a void or bubble **701** (labeled as “3”) is provided within or adjacent to a piezo element **716** (labeled as “4”) of a pump. The void or bubble **701** includes gas, such as gas stored at a pressure exceeding the operating pressure of the pump. For example, if the pressure at region 2 in FIG. 7 exceeds a pressure threshold (e.g., falls below -200 mmHg or another suitable threshold value), then the void or bubble **701** bursts and thereby stops operation of the pump. For example, if the bubble **701** ruptures, the piezo element will become inoperative and the pump will no longer work. In other embodiments, the wiring to the piezo element or pump can run across the surface of the bubble (and/or inside the bubble). In such embodiment, bursting of the bubble could sever the wire and thereby stop or discontinue operation of the pump. The illustrated and described embodiments are not limited to pumps operated by piezoelectric transducers. For example, a void or bubble can be used to deactivate or render inoperative voice coil pumps, diaphragm pumps, etc.

(63) Further elements can be incorporated into the device to increase the usability of this device. For example, one or more of speaker(s) and/or vibration indicator(s) can be included. The pump can be operated via a controller. One or more user interface elements for operating the pump can be included.

(64) FIG. 8 illustrates an integrated wound dressing **800** with the pump and electronics package incorporated within the dressing according to some embodiments. The dressing is similar to that described with reference to FIGS. 3-7, except that the dressing **800** includes a different spacer layer and absorbent layer arrangement. The spacer layer comprises a channel **801** that forms a ring about the wound dressing. The absorbent layer **812** is surrounded by the spacer channel **801**. There are additional channels **802** formed in the absorbent layer. The channels **801** and **802** form chambers that can facilitate evaporation of fluid as is explained above in connection with FIG. 4.

(65) FIGS. 9A-9B illustrate integrated wound dressing **900** according to some embodiments. As illustrated in FIG. 9A, the integrated wound dressing **900** comprises a tube **901** filled with magnetic fluid (or a solid magnet **901**). As illustrated in FIG. 9B, the tube **901** can be positioned on the perimeter of the spacer layer **911** and/or absorbent layer **912**, and the tube **901** can run along or across the dressing **900**. FIG. 9A also illustrates a coil of wire **902** excited by sinusoidal or other potential difference between points A and B. That is, the pump is actuated by electromagnetic field

(for example, the pump can be a voice coil pump). The dressing further comprises one or more pump chambers **903** positioned on the dressing as illustrated in FIG. **9A**. Each of the pump chambers **903** can include one or more one-way valves. In some embodiments, the pump chambers can have an additional membrane or piston positioned between the magnetic field and chamber. (66) As shown in FIG. **9B**, the wound dressing can include a wound contact layer **910** and a moisture vapor permeable top film or cover layer **913**. The perimeter of the cover layer **913** can seal to the perimeter of the wound contact layer enclosing the components of the wound dressing apparatus.

(67) FIGS. **10-12** show embodiments of integrated dressings. FIG. **10** illustrates a close up view of one end of the wound dressing. The pump **1016** is visible as a dark spot under the top layer.

(68) FIG. **11A** shows a top view of a wound dressing where the pump and associated components are visible. The pump **1116**, electronics package **1115**, switch **1160** for operating the pump (e.g., turning the pump on/off), and power source **1114** are visible from the top of the dressing.

(69) FIG. **11B** shows a bottom view of a wound dressing where recesses for the pump and associated components are visible. Recess **1216** can be a pump recess, recess **1215** can be an electronics package recess, and recess **1214** can be a power source recess.

(70) In some embodiments, the pump and/or other electronic components can be configured to be positioned adjacent to or next to the absorbent and/or transmission layers so that the pump and/or other electronic components are still part of a single apparatus to be applied to a patient, but the pump and/or other electronics are positioned away from the wound site.

(71) In some embodiments, the pump and/or other electronic components can be configured to be positioned adjacent to or next to the absorbent and/or transmission layers so that the pump and/or other electronic components are still part of a single apparatus to be applied to a patient with the pump and/or other electronics positioned away from the wound site. FIGS. **12A-12B** illustrates a wound dressing incorporating the source of negative pressure and/or other electronic components within the wound dressing. FIGS. **12A-12B** illustrates a wound dressing **1200** with the pump and/or other electronics positioned away from the wound site. The wound dressing can include an electronics area **1261** and an absorbent area **1260**. The dressing can comprise a wound contact layer (not shown) and a moisture vapor permeable film or cover layer **1213** positioned above the contact layer and other layers of the dressing. The wound dressing layers and components of the electronics area as well as the absorbent area can be covered by one continuous cover layer **1213** as shown in FIGS. **12A-12B**.

(72) The electronics area **1261** can include a source of negative pressure (such as a pump) and some or all other components of the TNP system, such as power source(s), sensor(s), connector(s), user interface component(s) (such as button(s), switch(es), speaker(s), screen(s), etc.) and the like, that can be integral with the wound dressing. For example, the electronics area **1261** can include a button or switch **1211** as shown in FIG. **12A-12B**. The button or switch **1211** can be used for operating the pump (e.g., turning the pump on/off).

(73) The absorbent area **1260** can include an absorbent material **1212** and can be positioned over the wound site. The electronics area **1261** can be positioned away from the wound site, such as by being located off to the side from the absorbent area **1260**. The electronics area **1261** can be positioned adjacent to and in fluid communication with the absorbent area **1260** as shown in FIGS. **12A-12B**. In some embodiments, each of the electronics area **1261** and absorbent area **1260** may be rectangular in shape and positioned adjacent to one another.

(74) In some embodiments, additional layers of dressing material can be included in the electronics area **1261**, the absorbent area **1260**, or both areas. In some embodiments, the dressing can comprise one or more spacer layers and/or one or more absorbent layer positioned above the contact layer and below the wound cover layer **1213** of the dressing.

(75) The dressing can comprise a wound contact layer (not shown), a spacer layer (not shown), an absorbent layer **1212**, a moisture vapor permeable film or cover layer **1213** positioned above the

wound contact layer, spacer layer, absorbent layer, or other layers of the dressing. The wound contact layer can be configured to be in contact with the wound. The wound contact layer can include an adhesive on the patient facing side for securing the dressing to the surrounding skin or on the top side for securing the wound contact layer to a cover layer or other layer of the dressing. In operation, the wound contact layer can be configured to provide unidirectional flow so as to facilitate removal of exudate from the wound while blocking or substantially preventing exudate from returning to the wound. The first spacer layer assists in distributing negative pressure over the wound site and facilitating transport of wound exudate and fluids into the wound dressing. In some embodiments, the spacer layer can be formed at least partially from a three dimensional (3D) fabric. Further, an absorbent layer (such as layer **1212**) for absorbing and retaining exudate aspirated from the wound can be utilized. In some embodiments, a superabsorbent material can be used in the absorbent layer **1212**. In some embodiments, the absorbent includes a shaped form of a superabsorber layer. The wound dressing layers of the electronics area and the absorbent layer can be covered by one continuous cover layer **1213**. In some embodiments, the cover layer can include a moisture vapor permeable material that prevents liquid exudate removed from the wound and other liquids from passing through, while allowing gases through.

(76) FIG. **13A** illustrates a wound dressing with the pump and/or other electronics positioned away from the wound site. The wound dressing can include an electronics area **1361** and an absorbent area **1360**. The absorbent area **1360** can include an absorbent material **1312** and can be positioned over the wound site. The electronics area **1361** can be positioned away from the wound site, such as by being located off to the side from the absorbent area **1360**. The electronics area **1361** can be positioned adjacent to and in fluid communication with the absorbent area **1360**. In some embodiments, each of the electronics area **1361** and absorbent area **1360** may be rectangular in shape, and positioned adjacent to one another to form a T-shape. In such an embodiment, each of the areas **1360** and **1361** are elongated with longitudinal axes that are perpendicular or substantially perpendicular to one another. As shown in FIG. **13A**, the top portion of the T can be where the electronics would be located, and the bottom of the T can be placed on the wound.

(77) FIG. **13B** illustrates an embodiment of layers of a wound dressing with the pump and electronic components offset from the absorbent area of the dressing. As illustrated in FIG. **13B**, the dressing can include a wound contact layer **1310** for placing in contact with the wound. Lower spacer layers **1311** and **1311'** are provided above the wound contact layer **1310**. In some embodiments, the spacer layer **1311** can be a separate layer from spacer layer **1311'** as shown in FIG. **13B**. The lower spacer layers **1311** and/or **1311'** can assist in distributing pressure evenly to the wound surface and/or wicking fluid away from the wound. An absorbent layer **1322** can be positioned above the lower spacer layer **1311**. A dressing layer **1351** can include cutouts or recesses **1328** for embedding the electronic components **1350** within the layer **1351**. In some embodiments, the cutouts or recesses **1328** can be sized and shaped to embed a pump **1327**, power source **1326**, and/or other electronic components. In some embodiments, the layer **1351** can include multiple spacer layers stacked together. In some embodiments, the layer **1351** can include multiple spacer layers pieced together to surround the electronic components **1350**. An upper spacer layer can be provided above the absorbent layer **1322**, layer **1351**, and/or electronic components **1350**. A cover layer or backing layer **1313** can be positioned over the upper spacer layer. The backing layer **1313** can form a seal to the wound contact layer **1310** at a perimeter region enclosing the spacer layers **1311**, **1311'**, and **1317**, the absorbent layer **1322**, layer **1351**, and electronic components **1350**. In some embodiments, the backing layer **1313** can be a flexible sheet of material that forms and molds around the dressing components when they are applied to the wound. In other embodiments, the backing layer **1313** can be a material that is preformed or premolded to fit around the dressing components as shown in FIG. **13B**.

(78) FIG. **14** illustrates an embodiment of a wound dressing with the pump and electronic components offset from the absorbent area of the dressing positioned over the wound. The wound

dressings can comprise a wound contact layer **1310** and a moisture vapor permeable film or cover layer **1313** that enclose an absorbent area **1360** and an electronics area **1361**. The cover layer **1313** can seal at the perimeter of the cover layer **1319** to the wound contact layer **1310** at the perimeter of the wound contact layer. The dressing can comprise an upper spacer layer or first spacer layer **1317** that includes a continuous layer of spacer material positioned below the cover layer **1313** and above the layers of the absorbent area and the layers of the electronics area. The continuous layer of spacer material or upper spacer layer **1317** can enable an air pathway between the two areas of the dressing as illustrated by black directional arrows in FIG. **14**.

(79) The absorbent area **1360** of the dressing can comprise a second spacer layer **1311** or lower spacer layer and an absorbent layer **1322** positioned above the wound contact layer **1310**. The second spacer layer **1311** can allow for an open air path over the wound site. The absorbent layer **1322** can comprise a super absorber positioned in the absorbent area **1360** of the dressing. The absorbent layer **1322** can retain wound fluid within thereby preventing fluid passage of wound exudates into the electronics area **1361** of the dressing. The wound fluids can flow through the wound contact layer **1310**, to the lower spacer layer **1311**, and into the absorbent layer **1322**. The wound fluids are then spread throughout the absorbent layer **1322** and retained in the absorbent layer **1322** as shown by the white directional arrows for wound fluids in FIG. **14**.

(80) The electronics area **1361** of the dressing can comprise a plurality of layers of spacer material **1351**. In some embodiments, the electronic components **1350** embedded within the plurality of layers of spacer material **1351**. The layers of spacer material can have recesses or cut outs to embed the electronic components within whilst providing structure to prevent collapse. The electronic components **1350** can include a pump, power source, controller, and/or an electronics package, although any suitable electronics component is appreciated. In some embodiments, a barrier and/or partition can be provided between the absorbent area **1360** and the dressing layers surrounding the electronic components in the electronics area **1361**. A partition **1362** can optionally be positioned between the absorbent area **1360** and the electronics area **1361**. The partition **1362** can separate the absorbent layer **1322** and lower air flow spacer layer **1311** from the electronic housing segment of the dressing in the electronic area. The partition **1362** can prevent wound fluid (e.g., wound exudate) from entering the electronic housing section of the dressing. In some embodiments, the partition can be a non-porous dam or other structure. The non-porous dam **1362** can comprise a cyanoacrylate adhesive bead or a strip of silicone. The air pathway through the dressing is shown in FIG. **14** by directional arrows. The air flows through the wound contact layer **1310**, the lower spacer layer **1311**, and the absorbent layer **1322** and into the first spacer layer **1317**. The air can travel horizontally through the first spacer layer **1317** over and around the partition **1362** into the electronics area of the dressing as illustrated by the black directional arrows in FIG. **14**.

(81) A pump exhaust **1370** can be provided to exhaust air from the pump to the outside of the dressing. The pump exhaust can be in communication with the electronics area **1361** and the outside of the dressing. In some embodiments, the pump exhaust **1370** can be a flexible fluidic connector that comprises a 3D material that allows for pressure to be applied without collapse of the exhaust port as described in more detail herein. Examples of an application where additional disclosure relating to the 3D material can be found include US Publication No. 2015/0141941, titled "Apparatuses and Methods for Negative Pressure Wound Therapy" published on May 21, 2015. The disclosure of this patent is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

(82) FIGS. **15-27** show embodiments of the wound dressing with the electronic components **1350** offset from the absorbent material **1322** of the dressing. FIGS. **15-27** show the wound dressing similar to the dressing described with reference to FIG. **14**. In FIG. **15** the dressing is shown with the portion of the upper or first spacer layer **1317** over the electronic area **1361** folded back and exposing an underlying spacer layer of the plurality of spacer layers **1351** in the electronics area **1361**.

(83) FIGS. **16** and **17** show a top view of the wound dressing with the electronic components **1350**

offset from the absorbent layer **1322** with the continuous upper or first spacer layer **1317** shown over the absorbent area **1360** and the electronics area **1361**.

(84) FIG. **18** shows the dressing with a portion of the top or first spacer layer **1317** over the electronic area folded back and exposing underlying spacer layer **1351** in the electronics area and the electronic components **1350**. FIG. **19** shows one of the plurality of spacer layers **1351** being removed and exposing the underlying electronic components **1350**. FIG. **20** shows one of the plurality of spacer layers **1351** with recesses in spacer layer with an electronic component embedded within the recess.

(85) FIGS. **21-23** shows the wound dressing with the electronic components **1350** exposed and the recessed spacer layers removed. At least one of the plurality of transmission layers **1351** are provided below the electronic components **1350** for cushioning as shown in FIGS. **21-23**. FIG. **24** shows an embodiment of a wound dressing with a spacer layer **1351** with recesses provided around the electronic components **1350**. FIGS. **25-26** show the wound dressing with pieces of spacer material **1351a** placed around the electronic components **1350**. FIG. **27** shows the wound dressing with the pieces of spacer material **1351a** and an additional layer of spacer material **1351** provided over it. In some embodiments, the dressing material in the electronics area can be a material that has the same compressibility as the absorbent material. This can allow for the electronics area to have a uniform surface with the absorbent area when compressed.

(86) The dressings described in FIGS. **13-27** incorporate electronic components in a portion of the dressing offset from the portion of the dressing placed over the wound. Components can be incorporated into the dressing to provide a barrier that stops liquid from entering into the area near the electronics. One of those methods described with reference to FIG. **14** includes the use of a partition or non-porous dam positioned between a portion of the electronics area and the absorbent area. In some embodiments, the dressing can be composed of two separate pouches and a port that connects the two pouches with a filter over the negative pressure port. For example, the dressing can include an electronics pouch and a dressing pouch and the wound dressing can utilize a fluidic connector positioned between the two pouches. The two pouches can be connected or enclosed by a wound contact layer and wound cover layer sealed around the two pouches thereby incorporating the pouches into one dressing unit. In some embodiments, the fluidic connector in communication with the two pouches can be a flexible fluidic connector that comprises a 3D material that allows for pressure to be applied without collapse of the connector. Examples of an application where additional disclosure relating to the fluidic connector can be found include US Publication No. 2015/0141941, titled "Apparatuses and Methods for Negative Pressure Wound Therapy" published on May 21, 2015. The disclosure of this patent is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

(87) In some embodiments, the absorbent components and electronics components can be overlapping but offset. For example, a portion of the electronics area can overlap the absorbent area, for example overlapping the superabsorber layer, but the electronics area is not completely over the absorbent area. Therefore, a portion of the electronics area can be offset from the absorbent area and only provided over the cushioning spacer layers.

(88) FIG. **28A** is a side cross-sectional view of a wound dressing system **1300**, according to some embodiments. FIG. **28A** illustrates a cross-sectional view of the wound dressing system with components of the wound dressing system similar to the wound dressing system as illustrated in FIG. **14**. Unless otherwise noted, reference numerals and like-named components in FIG. **28A** refer to components that are the same as or generally similar to the components of FIG. **14**. As shown in FIG. **28A**, the wound dressing system **1300** can include a wound dressing **1302** with one or more embedded (also referred to as integrated) electronic components **1350**. The wound dressing **1302** can include a wound dressing body **1332** and a wound dressing border **1334**. The wound dressing border **1334** can extend around at least a portion of the perimeter of the wound dressing body **1332**. For example, in some embodiments, the wound dressing border **1334** can extend around the entire perimeter of the wound dressing body **1332**. The wound dressing border **1334** can extend away

from the wound dressing body **1332** any suitable distance (also referred to as the border length), such as, for example, a distance in the range of about 0.5 cm to about 3.0 cm, although any suitable distance is contemplated, including distances shorter than 0.5 cm or longer than 3.0 cm. Different portions of the wound dressing border **1334** can have different border lengths. For example, for wound dressings **1302** that have generally rectangular shapes, the border lengths of the four corners can be longer relative to the border lengths of the four straight portions of the wound dressing border **1334**. The wound dressing **1302** can include an absorbent area **1360** and an electronics area **1361**. In some embodiments, the electronic components **1350** can be positioned within the wound dressing **1302** in the electronics area **1361**, although it should be appreciated that the electronic components **1350** can be integrated with the wound dressing **1302** in any suitable arrangement (e.g., disposed on and/or positioned within the wound dressing **1302**, among others). The electronic components **1350** can optionally include a pump **1304**, a power source, a controller, and/or an electronics package, although any suitable electronic component is appreciated. The pump **1304** can be in fluidic communication with one or more regions of the wound dressing **1302**, such as, for example, the absorbent area **1360** of the dressing. The absorbent area **1360** and the electronics area **1361** of the wound dressing **1302** can have any suitable arrangement. For example, FIG. **28A** illustrates an embodiment of the wound dressing **1302** in which the electronics area **1361** is offset from the absorbent area **1360**.

(89) As shown in FIG. **28A**, the wound dressing system **1300** can include a switch **1330** to control the operation of the wound dressing system **1300**. The switch **1330** can be integrated with the wound dressing **1302**. For example, in some embodiments, the switch **1330** can be integrated with the wound dressing body **1332** or the wound dressing border **1334**. The switch can be positioned within, disposed on, and/or embedded in the wound dressing body **1332** or the wound dressing border **1334**, although it should be appreciated that the switch **1330** can be integrated with any suitable part of the wound dressing **1302**. For example, as described in more detail below, in some embodiments, the switch **1330** can be positioned over a flexiboard layer and/or positioned on a tab. The flexiboard layer and/or tab can allow for the switch **1330** to be actuated (e.g. activated, deactivated, and/or selected) without causing trauma or discomfort to users' wound sites. Accordingly, even when users actuate the switch **1330** with compressive and/or shear forces (e.g., from pushing down on the switch or pressing on the switch in a plurality of directions), the flexiboard layer and/or tab advantageously inhibits or reduces the amount of force transferred to users' wound sites. For example, the flexiboard layer can absorb and/or dissipate forces before they reach the wound site.

(90) The switch can be electrically connected to one or more of the electrical components **1350** of the wound dressing system **1300**. For example, in some embodiments, the switch **1330** can be electrically connected to the pump **1304**, a power source, a controller, and/or an electronics package, although any suitable electronic component is appreciated. In some embodiments, the switch can be wired and/or be in wireless communication with one or more of the electrical components **1350**. The switch **1330** can be selectively operable to control one or more of the electrical components **1350**. For example, in some embodiments, the switch can be actuated by users to turn on and turn off the pump **1304** and/or a power source. In some embodiments, the switch **1330** can be selectively operable by users to control one or more operating conditions of the pump **1304** (e.g., to toggle through a plurality of operating states or levels of the pump **1304**) in addition to or instead of powering on and powering off the wound dressing system **1300**. For example, the switch **1330** can be electrically connected to a controller of the wound dressing system **1300** such that users can control various features of the pump **1304**, including, for example, the negative pressure level delivered by the pump **1304** (e.g., pressure levels in the range of about -40 mmHg to -150 mmHg, among others), the type of pressure wave delivered by the pump **1304** (e.g., sinusoidal, sawtooth, and the like), and/or the operating mode of the pump **1304** (e.g., continuous or intermittent). For example, in some embodiments, one press of the switch **1330** can

turn on the pump **1304** and cause the pump **1304** to deliver a target pressure of -40 mmHg, two presses of the switch **1330** after the pump **1304** has been turned on can cause the pump **1304** to deliver a target pressure of -80 mmHg, and holding the switch **1330** down for a predetermined amount of time (e.g., 2 seconds) can cause the pump **1304** to turn off. Other actuation combinations for controlling the wound dressing system **1300** with the switch **1330** are also appreciated. In some embodiments, a plurality of switches can be integrated with the wound dressing **1302** to control the wound dressing system **1300**.

(91) FIG. **28B** is a perspective view of a wound dressing system **1300** with a switch **1330** embedded into a wound dressing border **1334**, according to some embodiments. FIG. **28C** also includes a magnified partial perspective view of the corner of the wound dressing system **1300** that includes the switch **1330**. Unless otherwise noted, reference numerals and like-named components in FIGS. **28B** and **28C** refer to components that are the same as or generally similar to the components of FIG. **28A**. As shown in FIG. **28B**, the wound dressing system **1300** can include an exhaust system **1370** to exhaust air from a pump embedded in the wound dressing **1302** to the outside of the wound dressing **1302** (e.g., to the environment). The exhaust system **1370** can be similar to the exhaust system described in more detail below.

(92) As shown in FIGS. **28B** and **28C**, the switch **1330** can optionally be positioned on a corner of the wound dressing border **1334**. However, it should be appreciated that the switch **1330** can be integrated with the wound dressing border **1334** or the wound dressing body **1332** at any suitable location. In some embodiments, the switch **1330** can optionally be positioned in a sub-flush position relative to the cover layer **1313** to inhibit or prevent accidental and/or inadvertent actuation of the switch **1330** (e.g., from a user laying on the wound dressing **1302**). For example, a bottom surface of the switch **1330** can be positioned below a top surface of the cover layer **1313** (e.g., so that the height of the switch **1330** does not extend past a plane defined by the wound dressing border **1334**).

(93) The partially magnified perspective view of the corner in FIG. **28C** shows that the wound dressing system **1300** can include one or more indicators **1331**. The one or more indicators **1331** can extend (e.g., circumferentially extend) around at least a portion of the perimeter of the switch **1330**. The one or more indicators **1331** can indicate one or more statuses of the wound dressing system **1330**, such as, for example, battery level (e.g., above 30% remaining and 30% or less remaining), pressure level (e.g., a first pressure level and a second pressure level), operating problems (e.g., a leak and/or a blockage condition), among any other suitable statuses. In some embodiments, the one or more indicators **1331** can include one or more visual indicators, audio indicators, tactile indicators, and the like. For example, in some embodiments, the one or more indicators **1331** can include one or more light emitting diodes (LEDs). The one or more indicators can include an array of LEDs. In some embodiments, one or more LEDs can, for example, flash or illuminate in a particular color to indicate a particular operating status. For example, the one or more LEDs can flash to indicate the presence of an operating problem (e.g., a leak and/or a blockage condition), illuminate in a solid color to indicate a battery level (e.g., illuminate solid green for a battery level above a threshold percentage (e.g., 30%) and illuminate solid orange for a battery level at or below the threshold percentage). In some embodiments, the switch **1330** can be used to power on and power off one or more electrical components of the wound dressing system **1300**, such as, for example, a pump, a power source, a controller, and/or an electronics package, among others. For example, the switch **1330** can be electrically connected to one or more such electrical components via a wire conduit **1340** shown in the partially magnified perspective view in FIG. **28C**. The wire conduit **1340** can pass between layers of the dressing. For example, in some embodiments, the wire conduit **1340** can be positioned between the cover layer **1313** and a bottom wound contact layer (not shown).

(94) FIGS. **29A** and **29B** are two views of the switch **1330** of FIGS. **28B** and **28C** integrated with a wound dressing **1302**, according to some embodiments. FIG. **29A** is a perspective view of the

switch **1330** positioned above a flexiboard layer **1336** and FIG. **29B** is a side cross-sectional view of the switch **1330** positioned above the flexiboard layer **1336**. Unless otherwise noted, reference numerals and like-named components in FIGS. **29A** and **29B** refer to components that are the same as or generally similar to the components of FIGS. **28A-28C**. As shown in FIG. **29A**, the cover layer **1313** of the wound dressing **1302** can include a plurality of holes **1335** (also referred to as breathing pores) to allow air to circulate through the wound dressing border **1334**. The flexiboard layer **1336** can be positioned below the cover layer **1313** and the switch **1330** so that when the switch **1330** is actuated (e.g., the switch is pressed, or a force is applied to it) the flexiboard layer **1336** inhibits or reduces the amount of force transferred to the wound site and surrounding tissue. The flexiboard layer **1336** can be any suitable rigid, semi-rigid, and/or semi-flexible material capable of dissipating compression forces on the wound dressing **1302**. The extent of the flexiboard layer **1336** in FIG. **29A** is shown by the plurality of holes **1335** in the cover layer **1313** that are shaded. The wound contact layer **1310** is shown in FIG. **29A** by the plurality of holes **1335** in the cover layer **1313** that are not shaded. In some embodiments, the flexiboard layer **1336** can extend outward from the center of the switch **1330** in the range of about 0.5 cm to 3.0 cm, although any suitable distance is appreciated, including distances shorter than 0.5 cm and distances greater than 3.0 cm. In some embodiments, the one or more indicators **1331** can include a first indicator **1331a** and a second indicator **1331b**, although any suitable number is appreciated.

(95) FIG. **29B** is similar to FIG. **29A** except that FIG. **29B** is a side cross-sectional view of the switch **1330** of FIGS. **28B** and **28C** embedded in the wound dressing border **1334**. As shown in FIG. **29B**, the switch **1330** can be positioned above a flexiboard layer **1336**. The flexiboard layer **1336** can extend a distance away from a center of the switch **1330**. In some embodiments, the flexiboard layer **1336** can extend the width of the wound dressing border **1334** (e.g., the width defined between the wound dressing body **1332** and the outer edge of the wound dressing border **1334**). In some embodiments, the one or more indicators **1331** can be positioned adjacent the switch **1330** (e.g., can extend around or can extend circumferentially around the switch **1330**). A cover layer **1313** can be positioned around the one or more indicators **1331** and the switch **1330** and on top of the flexiboard layer **1336**. The flexiboard layer **1336** can be positioned above the wound contact layer **1310**. As shown in FIG. **29B**, the switch **1330** can be positioned in a sub-flush position relative to the one or more indicators **1331** to reduce the likelihood of accidental/inadvertent actuation of the switch **1330**. A forefinger is shown depressing the switch **1330**. In some embodiments, the switch **1330** can be actuated by pressing the switch **1330** in a first direction with a forefinger (e.g., a downward direction).

(96) FIGS. **30A** and **30B** are two views of a switch **1330** integrated with a tab **1338** that extends away from a wound dressing border **1334**, according to some embodiments. FIG. **30A** is a perspective view of the switch **1330** positioned on the tab **1338** and FIG. **30B** is a side cross-sectional view of the switch **1330** positioned on the tab **1338**, with the tab **1338** lifted at an angle relative to a plane of the wound dressing **1302**. Unless otherwise noted, reference numerals and like-named components in FIGS. **30A** and **30B** refer to components that are the same as or generally similar to the components of FIGS. **28A-29B**. As shown in FIG. **30A**, the tab **1338** can be attached to a peripheral edge of the wound dressing border **1334**, although any other suitable location is appreciated, such as, for example, the middle of the wound dressing border **1334** or an edge of the wound dressing body **1332**, among others. The wound dressing **1302** can optionally include a joint **1339** (also referred to as a seam, a crease, and/or a border) where the tab **1338** and the wound dressing border **1334** attach (or otherwise come together). The joint **1339** can advantageously allow the tab to pivot (also referred to as rotate) about the joint **1339** (e.g., like a hinge) so that users can optionally move the tab **1338** before actuating the switch **1330**. In some embodiments, the tab **1338** can have a rest position in which it abuts up against the wound dressing border **1334** (e.g., extends along the same plane as the wound dressing border **1334**), the wound dressing body, and/or the patient before a user moves the tab **1338**. In some embodiments, the tab

1338 can be lifted about the joint **1339** (e.g., so that it extends at an angle relative to the wound dressing border **1334** and is not in contact with the patient's skin) so that no force is transferred to the patient's body when the switch **1330** is actuated. For example, in some embodiments, the switch **1330** can be actuated by applying a force to the switch **1330** in two opposing directions, such as, for example, on first and second sides of the tab **1338a**, **1338b** (e.g., by pressing the switch with two fingers, as shown in FIG. **30B**). The tab **1338** can therefore allow users to lift up the tab **1338**, which advantageously inhibits (e.g., prevents) trauma to the wound and surrounding tissue by actuating the switch **1330**, as shown by the two fingers in FIG. **30B** (e.g., between a thumb and a forefinger). FIG. **30B** shows that the switch **1330** and the one or more indicators **1331** can be attached to the underside of the cover layer **1313**. In some embodiments, a flexiboard **1336** can optionally be attached to the tab **1338**, such as, for example, below the switch **1330**. In some embodiments, the electrical connection between the switch **1330** and the pump in the wound dressing can be positioned between the cover layer **1313** and the wound contact layer **1310**, although any suitable arrangement is appreciated. As shown in FIG. **30B**, the switch **1330** can be positioned in a sub-flush position relative to the one or more indicators **1331** to reduce the likelihood of accidental/inadvertent actuation of the switch **1330**.

(97) FIGS. **30C-3E** show embodiments of wound dressings with a switch **1330** integrated into the wound dressing border **1334**. In some embodiments, the switch **1330** can be electrically connected to one or more such electrical components via a wire conduit **1340** shown in FIGS. **30C-3D**. The wire conduit **1340** can pass between layers of the dressing. For example, in some embodiments, the wire conduit **1340** can be positioned between a backing or cover layer and a bottom wound contact layer. FIG. **30A** illustrates a wound dressing with integrated switch at the wound dressing boarder before negative pressure is applied. FIG. **30D** illustrates a wound dressing with integrated switch at the wound dressing boarder after negative pressure is applied. As shown in FIG. **30D**, when negative pressure is applied, the wound dressing components are pulled downward and an imprint of the electronic components **1350** is visible in the electronics area of the dressing. FIG. **30E** shows the wound dressing components with the backing layer and wound contact layer removed. The switch **1330** is shown adjacent to the dressing layers of the electronics area **1360** and the wire conduit and/or electrical connections **1340** are shown extending from the switch to the electronics area **1360** of the dressing.

(98) As described previously, FIG. **11** illustrates a top view of a wound dressing system with a switch **1160** embedded within a wound dressing body, according to some embodiments. The pump **1116**, electronic components **1115**, and switch **1160** for operating the pump (e.g., turning the pump on/off), and power source **1114** are visible from the top of the wound dressing. As shown in FIG. **11A**, a dressing layer can be positioned over the switch **1160** to keep it sterile.

(99) As shown in FIG. **28A**, the negative pressure wound therapy system **1300** can include an exhaust system **1370** (also referred to as a dressing exhaust or a pump exhaust) to exhaust air from the pump **1304** to the outside of the wound dressing **1302** (e.g., to the environment). In some embodiments, the exhaust system **1370** can be in communication with the electronics area **1361** and the environment outside of the dressing **1302**. As described in more detail below, in some embodiments, the exhaust system **1370** can be a flexible fluidic connector (also referred to as a flexible port) that includes a 3D material that allows for pressure (e.g., a compression force applied via compression of the wound dressing **1302**) to be applied to the exhaust system **1370** without causing the collapse of its exhaust port. Accordingly, even when the wound dressing **1302** and exhaust system **1370** is subjected to a compression force (e.g., from the patient laying on the wound dressing **1302**), the exhaust system **1370** advantageously exhausts air from the wound site while inhibiting the collapse and occlusion of the exhaust pathway. Examples of an application where additional disclosure relating to the 3D material can be found include US Publication No. 2015/0141941, titled "Apparatuses and Methods for Negative Pressure Wound Therapy" published on May 21, 2015. The disclosure of this patent is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety.

(100) FIG. 31A is a top view of the exhaust system **1370** of FIG. 28A shown coupled to an outlet of a pump **1304**, according to some embodiments. The wound dressing **1302** has been removed for purposes of illustration. The pump **1304** includes an inlet **1304a** and an outlet **1304b**. As shown in FIG. 31A, the exhaust system **1370** can include a connector **1376** including a spacer **1372** enveloped (also referred to as embedded) in a film **1374**. In some embodiments, the film **1374** can define a chamber and the spacer **1372** can be positioned within the chamber. The connector **1376** can define a flow path through which gas (e.g., air) exhausted from the pump **1304** can flow through. The flow path can include a portion of the chamber. In some embodiments, the flow path can include the entire chamber. Advantageously, the spacer **1372** can resist collapse of the connector **1376** when the connector **1376** is compressed, thereby inhibiting the flow path of the connector **1376** from becoming occluded. The spacer **1372** can be any suitable 3D material capable of resisting compression in at least one direction, thereby enabling effective transmission of exhaust air therethrough. In some embodiments, the spacer **1372** can be flexible and capable of returning to its original shape after being deformed. In some embodiments, the 3D material can be constructed from antibacterial and/or antimicrobial filter materials so that the pump **1304** can exhaust filtered gases into the atmosphere. In some embodiments, the spacer **1372** can be freely movable within the film **1374**. In some embodiments, the spacer **1372** can be freely movable within a chamber defined between top and bottom layers of the film **1374**. Any suitably sized spacer **1372** is appreciated.

(101) The film **1374** can be a clear plastic film, although any suitable material is appreciated, such as, for example, a Versapore film having a pore size diameter of about 2 μm . The film **1374** can be flexible. One or more edges of the film **1374** can provide a gas tight seal. The gas tight seal(s) can prevent air from the environment from leaking into the connector **1376**. In some embodiments, the film **1374** can include top and bottom layers of a clear plastic film (or other suitable material, e.g., Versapore). One or more edges of the top and bottom layers can be thermally bonded to each other to provide a gas tight seal that can prevent air from the environment from leaking into the connector **1376**. It should be appreciated that the gas tight seal along one or more edges (also referred to as one or more portions along a perimeter) of the connector **1376** can be sealed with any suitable process for any suitable film **1374** material. In some embodiments, the spacer **1372** can be freely movable within a chamber defined between the top and bottom layers of the film **1374**.

(102) As described above, the connector **1376** can define a flow path through which exhaust gas can flow. For example, in some embodiments, the flow path through the connector **1376** can extend between a first opening **1374a** and a second opening **1374b** of the film **1374**. The portion of the flow path extending between the first and second openings **1374a**, **1374b** can include one or more channels defined within the connector **1376**. In some embodiments, the one or more channels can define a generally tubular flow path that flows around the outside of the spacer **1372** but on the inside of the film **1374**. For example, in some embodiments, the one or more channels can be defined by the open space between one or more surfaces (also referred to as sides) of the spacer **1372** and one or more interior surfaces of the film **1374**. In some embodiments, the flow path can optionally include at least a portion of the spacer **1372**. For example, in some embodiments, the flow path between the first and second openings **1374a**, **1374b** can extend through a portion of the spacer **1372** (e.g., all of it) in addition to around the spacer **1372**. In some embodiments, the spacer **1372** can be positioned within the film **1374** such that the flow path between the first and second openings **1374a**, **1374b** only flows through the spacer. In some embodiments, the spacer **1372** can be disposed in the flow path to inhibit its occlusion. The second opening **1374b** of the connector **1376** can be open to the environment **1390** outside the wound dressing to which the pump **1304** is integrated. The first opening **1374a** of the film **1374** can connect to a pump or one or more other exhaust system **1370** features and components. In some embodiments, the first opening **1374a** can be positioned on the top of the film **1374**. In some embodiments, the first opening **1374a** can be positioned through an edge of the film **1374**.

(103) In some embodiments, the exhaust system **1370** can optionally include an extension conduit **1380** having any suitable length. The extension conduit **1380** can be used to connect the connector **1376** to a source of negative pressure, such as, for example, the outlet **1304b** of the pump **1304**. Although not shown in FIG. **31A**, the length of the extension conduit **1380** can advantageously position the connector **1376** outside of the wound dressing. A first end **1380a** of the extension conduit **1380** can be coupled to the first opening **1374a** of the film **1374**. In some embodiments, a portion of the extension conduit **1380** can extend (also referred to as inserted) into the connector **1376** through the first opening **1374a** before being attached to the connector **1376** to advantageously strengthen the attachment between the connector **1376** and the extension conduit **1380**. In some embodiments, a portion of the extension conduit **1380** can extend into the connector **1376** and be integrated with the spacer **1372** (e.g., embedded with the spacer **1372**). In some embodiments, a portion of the extension conduit **1380** can be enclosed in the spacer **1372**. A second end **1380b** of the extension conduit **1380** can be coupled to the outlet **1304b** of the pump **1304** to complete the flow path through the exhaust system **1370**. Once the extension conduit **1380** is connected to the pump **1304** and the connector **1376** is connected to the extension conduit **1380**, the flow path of the exhaust system **1370** can be complete.

(104) In some embodiments, the exhaust system **1370** does not include the optional extension conduit **1380**. In such embodiments, the connector **1376** can be connected to the outlet **1304b** of the pump **1304** such that the flow path of the exhaust system **1370** includes the flow path through the connector **1376**.

(105) As discussed above, the spacer **1372** can advantageously inhibit occlusion of the connector **1376**. The arrangement of the connector **1376** can also advantageously prevent ingress of water, foreign bodies, dirt, and/or bacteria from getting inside the wound dressing through the flow path of the connector **1376**.

(106) The exhaust system **1370** can pass through any suitable location on a wound dressing through an opening in the wound dressing. For example, in some embodiments, a portion of the exhaust system **1370** can pass through a top layer of the wound dressing. As another example, in some embodiments, a portion of the exhaust system **1370** can pass through an edge of the wound dressing (e.g., a border of the wound dressing), such as, for example, between a top layer and a bottom layer of the wound dressing. For example, FIG. **33C** is a schematic side view of an end of the exhaust system **1370** between a top layer and a bottom layer of the wound dressing. In some embodiments, the end of the exhaust system between the top and bottom layers can be the connector **1376**. In some embodiments, the end of the exhaust system between the top and bottom layers can be the extension conduit **1380**. In some embodiments, the top layer can include a moisture vapor permeable film and the bottom layer can include a wound contact layer, although any suitable top and bottom layers are appreciated. The exhaust system **1370** can form a gas tight seal where it passes through the opening in the wound dressing to advantageously prevent the ingress of water, foreign bodies, dirt, and/or bacteria into the wound dressing.

(107) In some embodiments, the exhaust system **1370** include one or more connectors **1376** and zero or more extension conduits **1380**.

(108) FIG. **31B** is a perspective view of the exhaust system **1370** of FIG. **28A** shown coupled to an outlet of a pump, according to some embodiments. Unless otherwise noted, reference numerals and like-named components in FIG. **31B** refer to components that are the same as or generally similar to the components of FIGS. **28A** and **31A**. FIG. **31B** is similar to FIG. **31A** except a compression source **1385** is clamped to the connector **1376** and the connector **1376** and the extension conduit **1380** have a different arrangement. The compression source **1385** is shown clamped to the connector **1376** to illustrate that the connector **1376** can resist a compression force. The clamp **1385** can be representative, for example, of a patient lying on the connector **1376**. In some embodiments, the clamping of the connector **1376**, such as with the clamp **1385**, can advantageously result in no more than about a 17.5% reduction in flow rate.

(109) As shown in FIG. 31B, in some embodiments, a portion of the extension conduit **1380** can be enveloped by the film **1374**. For example, in some embodiments, a distal portion **1380c** of the extension conduit **1380** can be embedded within the film **1374**. In some embodiments, a portion of the extension conduit **1380** can extend into the connector **1376** and attach to a portion of the spacer **1372**. In some embodiments, a portion of the extension conduit **1380** can extend into the connector **1376** and be integrated with a portion of the spacer **1372** (e.g., embedded with the spacer **1372**). In some embodiments, a proximal portion **1380d** of the extension conduit **1380** can be covered by one or more connectors, filters, dampeners, and/or insulators **1387**.

(110) In yet other embodiments, a portion of the extension conduit **1380** (e.g., an end of the extension conduit **1380**) can attach to an edge **1374c** of the film **1374**. In some embodiments, the edge **1374c** can include the first opening **1374a** of the film **1374** as described above with reference to FIG. 31A. In such embodiments, reference numeral **1380c** can instead refer to a flow path defined by the film **1374** instead of a distal portion **1380c** of the extension conduit **1380**. In such embodiments, the flow path defined by the film **1374c** can open into the region of the connector **1376** containing the spacer **1372**.

(111) FIGS. 32A and 32B illustrates a wound dressing system with components of the wound dressing system illustrated in FIGS. 18 and 23, respectively. Unless otherwise noted, reference numerals and like-named components in FIGS. 32A and 32B refer to components that are the same as or generally similar to the components of FIGS. 18 and 23, respectively. FIG. 32A shows the dressing with a portion of the top or first spacer layer **1317** over the electronic area folded back and exposing underlying spacer layer **1351** in the electronics area and the electronic components **1350**. The exhaust system **1370** is shown coupled to the pump **1304** with the optional extension conduit **1380**. In FIG. 32A, the length of the extension conduit **1380** has lengthened the exhaust system **1370** such that the connector **1376** is positioned outside of the wound dressing.

(112) FIG. 32B shows the wound dressing with the electronic components **1350** exposed and the recessed spacer layers removed. FIG. 32B is similar to FIG. 32A except that the exhaust system **1370** in FIG. 32B does not include the optional extension conduit **1380**. The exhaust system **1370** of FIG. 32B is coupled to the pump **1304** with the connector **1376**.

(113) FIG. 33A is a close up view of the connector **1376** and the extension conduit **1370** of FIG. 31B. Unless otherwise noted, reference numerals and like-named components in FIG. 33A refer to components that are the same as or generally similar to the components of FIGS. 28A and 31A-32B. In some embodiments, the extension conduit **1380** can include one or more ribs **1383**, which can act to secure the distal portion of the extension conduit **1380c** between top and bottom layers of the film **1374** (or in any other suitable fashion). In some embodiments, the one or more ribs **1383** can be circular in shape, although any suitable shape is appreciated. The one or more ribs **1383** can be formed in the extension conduit **1380** by grooves in a mold during the manufacturing of the extension conduit **1380**. During thermal bonding of top and bottom layers of the film **1374**, for example, melted material from the top and bottom layers can flow around the one or more ribs **1383**, advantageously providing a stronger connection between the extension conduit **1380** and the film **1374**. As a result, it may be more difficult to dislodge the extension conduit **1380** out from the film **1374** during use of the exhaust system **1370**. FIG. 33A also shows that the top and bottom layers of the film **1374** can be joined together so that the film **1374** defines a chamber **1378**. The chamber **1378** can house the spacer **1372**. In some embodiments, the spacer **1372** can optionally include a fold **1373**. The fold **1373** of the spacer **1372** can make the end of the connector **1376** softer and therefore more comfortable for a patient, and can also help prevent the extension conduit **1380** from blockage. The fold **1373** can further protect the end of the extension conduit **1380** (e.g., the first end of the extension conduit **1380a**) from being occluded by the top or bottom layers of the film **1374**. The fold **1373** can, in some embodiments, be between 1 cm and 3 cm (or between about 1 cm and about 3 cm) long, and in some embodiments is 2 cm (or about 2 cm) long. The spacer **1372** can be folded underneath itself, that is toward a bottom layer of the film **1374**, and in some

embodiments can be folded upward toward a top layer of the film **1374**. In some embodiments, the spacer **1372** may contain no fold.

(114) FIG. **33B** is a perspective exploded view the exhaust system **1370** of FIG. **33A**. As shown in FIG. **33B**, the film **1374** can include a top layer **1393** and a bottom layer **1392**. In some embodiments, the extension conduit **1380** can optionally include one or more connectors, filters, dampeners, and/or insulators **1387**. In some embodiments, a slot (also referred to as a channel) **1391** can extend perpendicularly away from the proximal end of the fold **1373**, and the extension conduit **1380** can rest in the slot **1391**. In some embodiments, the slot **1391** can extend through one layer of the fold, and in others it can extend through both layers of the fold. The slot **1391** can, in some embodiments, be 1 cm (or about 1 cm) long. Some embodiments can instead employ a circular or elliptical hole in the fold **1373**. The hole may face proximally so that the extension conduit **1380** can be inserted into the hole and rest between the folded layers of the spacer **1372**. In some embodiments, the extension conduit **1380** can be adhered to the material of the fold **1383**, while in other embodiments it may not.

(115) In some embodiments, a portion of the connector **1376** and/or the extension conduit **1380** (e.g., the top and/or bottom layers **1393**, **1392** of the film **1374**) can include a layer of adhesive, for example a pressure sensitive adhesive, to seal the exhaust system **1370** (e.g., a portion of the exhaust conduit **1380** and/or a portion of the connector **1376**) to a wound dressing. For example, in some embodiments, the connector **1376** can be sealed to one or more layers of the wound dressing (e.g., the cover layer, the wound contact layer, and the like).

(116) In some embodiments, the top layer **1393** of the film **1374** can be substantially the same shape as the bottom layer **1392** of the film **1374**. In some embodiments, the top layer **1393** and the bottom layer **1392** can be sealed together, for example, by heat welding and/or thermal bonding. In some embodiments, the bottom layer **1392** can be substantially flat and the top layer **1393** can be slightly larger than the bottom layer **1392** in order to accommodate the height of the spacer **1372** and seal to the bottom layer **1392**. In other embodiments, the top layer **1393** and the bottom layer **1392** can be substantially the same size, and the layers can be sealed together approximately at the middle of the height of the spacer **1372**. In some embodiments, the exhaust system **1370** can have a length in the range of about 0.3 cm to about 10 cm, although any suitable length is appreciated. In some embodiments, the bottom and top layers **1392**, **1393** of the film **1374** can include at least one layer of a flexible film, and in some embodiments can be transparent. In some embodiments, the bottom layer **1392** and the top layer **1393** can be polyurethane, and can be liquid impermeable.

(117) As described above, the connector **1376** can include a spacer **1372**, such as the 3D fabric discussed above, positioned between the lower layer **1392** and the top layer **1393** of the film **1374**. The spacer **1372** can be made of any suitable material, for example material resistant to collapsing in at least one direction, thereby enabling effective transmission of exhaust air therethrough.

Instead of or in addition to the 3D fabric discussed above, some embodiments of the spacer **1372** can comprise a fabric configured for lateral wicking of fluid, which may comprise viscose, polyester, polypropylene, cellulose, or a combination of some or all of these, and the material may be needle-punched. Some embodiments of the spacer **1372** can comprise polyethylene in the range of 40-160 grams per square meter (gsm) (or about 40 to about 160 gsm), for example 80 (or about 80) gsm. Such materials may be constructed so as to resist compression.

(118) As shown in FIG. **28A**, the wound dressing system **1300** can include a non-return valve **1410** to inhibit the back flow (also referred to as back leakage) of air into the wound dressing system **1300**. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can inhibit the back flow of air (e.g., from the environment) into the wound dressing system **1300** through the pump **1304**. As described in more detail below, the non-return valve **1410** can allow fluid flow in a first direction but inhibit fluid flow in a second direction, such as, for example, a second direction opposite the first direction, although any two directions are appreciated. In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be fluidically coupled to a portion of a flow path which extends between an outlet

of the pump **1304** and the environment. Such an arrangement can advantageously allow the wound dressing system **1300** to deliver a more stable target pressure to a wound site by inhibiting back flow that would otherwise cause the target pressure to be more varied. A non-return valve **1410** in fluid communication with the outlet of the pump **1304** can also advantageously make the pump more efficient by reducing the amount of power the pump consumes while it is drawing down and/or maintaining the dressing at a given target pressure.

(119) As shown in FIG. **28A**, in some embodiments, the flow path between the outlet of the pump **1304** and the environment can include an exhaust system **1370** to exhaust air from the pump **1304** to the outside of the wound dressing **1302** (e.g., to the environment). The non-return valve **1410** can be, for example, positioned in the flow path between the pump **1304** and the exhaust system **1370**, although it should be appreciated that the non-return valve **1410** can be positioned in any suitable portion of the flow path that extends between the pump **1304** and the environment. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be positioned on the inlet side of the pump between the wound dressing **1302** and an inlet to the pump **1304**. The exhaust system **1370** can be similar to the exhaust system described in detail herein with reference to FIGS. **31A-33C**. In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be optionally connected to the pump **1304** and/or the exhaust system **1370**. The non-return valve **1410** can be, for example, fitted (also referred to as connected or coupled) to the outlet of the pump **1304** and/or at least partially disposed in the pump **1304** (e.g., the outlet of the pump **1304**). Although not shown in FIG. **28A**, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can optionally be integrated with the exhaust system **1370**. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be positioned at the inlet or outlet of the exhaust system **1370** or be incorporated within it. As another example, in some embodiments, the wound dressing system **1300** may optionally not include the exhaust system **1370** altogether.

(120) In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can optionally be integrated with the wound dressing **1302** and/or with one or more embedded electronic components **1350** (e.g., the pump **1304**). The non-return valve **1410** can be, for example, sufficiently small to fit within the dimensional constraints of the wound dressing **1302**. In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be optionally positioned within and/or embedded in the wound dressing **1302**, such as, for example, in the electronics area **1361**. To fit within the wound dressing **1302**, the non-return valve **1410** can have any suitable size and shape. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can have a height that is less than a thickness of the wound dressing **1302** (e.g., a thickness between the cover layer **1313** and the wound contact layer **1310**). As another example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can have a length that is less than a length of the electronics area **1361** of the wound dressing **1302**.

(121) So that the non-return valve **1410** can inhibit back flow while also efficiently allowing for out flow through the wound dressing system **1300**, the non-return valve **1410** can advantageously have a low cracking pressure and a low resistance to out flow. A low cracking pressure and a low resistance to out flow can advantageously decrease the amount of power consumed during operation of the pump **1304** by decreasing the amount of resistance the pump **1304** must overcome to exhaust air. The use of a non-return valve **1410** can decrease the leak rate (also referred to as back flow) of the wound dressing system **1300** more than it decreases the pump rate of the wound dressing system **1300**. For example, in some embodiments, using the non-return valve **1410** can result in a total leak rate reduction of about 8.4% compared to a total pump rate reduction of about 7%, thereby resulting in an energy savings of approximately 1.4% from the use of the non-return valve **1410** alone. In some embodiments, the cracking pressure of the non-return valve **1410** can range from about 350 Pa to 500 Pa for a flow rate of about 1 mL/min (e.g., a flow rate of exactly 1 mL/min), although any suitable cracking pressure is appreciated (and at any suitable flow rate), such as, for example, about 100 Pa, 250 Pa, 400 Pa, 550 Pa, or less than about 1,000 Pa for flow rates of about 1 mL/min, among others (e.g., any suitable cracking pressure between 0 Pa and

1,000 Pa). The cracking pressure according the aforementioned values corresponds to the threshold pressure drop to open and reseal of the non-return valve **1410** for air flows having rate of about 1 mL/min. It should be appreciated that any other standardized flow rates can be used as well. In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** may not decrease the flow rate through the pump by more than 100 mL/min. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can decrease the flow rate through the pump between approximately 9.5 mL/min and approximately 24.5 mL/min, although other values of 100 mL/min or less are also appreciated. In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can have an out flow resistance in the range of about 5.0 mL/min to about 30 mL/min (measured with a nominally fixed vacuum of 10.7 kPa below atmosphere), although any suitable out flow resistance is appreciated, such as, for example, an out flow resistance of about 9.5 mL/min to about 24.5 mL/min, an out flow resistance of about 9.5 mL/min, an out flow resistance of about 14.6 mL/min, an out flow resistance of about 24.5 mL/min, and an out flow resistance of less than about 100 mL/min, among others (as measured with a nominally fixed vacuum of 10.7 kPa below atmosphere). In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** does not prevent all back flow. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can allow a negligible amount of air to leak into the wound dressing system **1300** through the outlet of the pump **1304**. For example, in some embodiments, the leakage rate of the non-return valve **1410** can be negligible such that the pump **1304** and the non-return valve **1410** have a combined leak rate of about 10.0 mL/min or less, such as, for example, 1.0 mL/min or less, 2.0 mL/min or less, 3.0 mL/min or less, 4.0 mL/min or less, or 5.0 mL/min or less. In some embodiments, the wound dressing system **1300** can establish a target vacuum in 50 seconds or less with a non-return valve **1410** incorporated with the wound dressing **1302** and/or the exhaust system **1370**. For example, in some embodiments, the wound dressing system **1300** can establish a target vacuum in about 5.1 seconds to 8.9 seconds, although any suitable time is appreciated.

(122) The non-return valve **1410** positioned in the out flow path of the wound dressing system **1300** can be a mechanical self-activated valve that does not need and/or use power to operate. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be a reed valve or a duckbill valve, although any suitable mechanical one-way valve is appreciated, such as, for example, a ball valve or an umbrella valve, among others. Various views of duckbill non-return valves **1410** are illustrated in FIGS. 34A-34D, with FIGS. 34C and 34D showing the duckbill valve **1410** coupled to a pump outlet **1304b**. FIGS. 35A-35C illustrate various views of various reed valves **1410** coupled to a pump outlet **1304b**. For example, FIG. 35A shows a reed valve **1410** having a cavity **1434** with an inlet port **1432** and an outlet port **1436** and a reed **1438** at least partially disposed in the cavity **1434**. The reed **1438** of the reed valve **1410** can occlude the flow path between the pump **1304** and the environment such that it allows fluid flow in a first direction (e.g., away from the pump) but inhibits fluid flow in a second direction (e.g., toward the pump). For example, in some embodiments, the reed **1438** can act as an encastered beam, with one end fixed and another end free to deflect. The sensitivity of the reed **1438** can be increased by increasing its length (i.e., longer reeds can be more sensitive than shorter reeds). For example, all else being equal, longer reeds can have lower cracking pressures and lower out flow resistances. In some embodiments, the reed **1438** can have a length in the range of about 3.0 mm to about 30 mm (e.g., as measured from the center of the non-return valve hole is seals to its opposite end). For example, in some embodiments, the reed **1438** has a length of about 10.5 mm, although any suitable length is appreciated. In some embodiments, the reed valve **1410** can be a 75 micron thick polyester reed valve, although any suitable thickness and material is appreciated.

(123) As shown in FIGS. 35A-35C, the shape of the non-return valve **1410** can be rectangular with two rounded ends. However, it will be understood that other suitable shapes can be provided. For example, FIGS. 36A-36C illustrate various views of a non-return valve **1410** having a crescent shape that can advantageously facilitate integration of the non-return valve **1410** into a wound dressing (e.g., wound dressing **1302** shown in FIG. 28A). For example, the crescent shape can

advantageously reduce the size of the non-return valve **1410** and make the wound dressing system **1300** more compact. As another example, the crescent shape can advantageously facilitate the attachment of the top surface **1440a** to a cover layer (not shown, but see cover layer **1313** in FIG. **28A**). For example, the curved top surface **1440a** of the crescent shape can help achieve a seal with the cover layer. The crescent shape can also advantageously streamline the upper surface of the wound dressing system in which it is incorporated by softening the edges of the non-return valve, thereby making the wound dressing system more comfortable to the user and at the same time making it less bulky. The upper curved surface **1440a** of the non-return valve **1410** can also reduce the likelihood of the non-return valve **1410** from becoming snagged by better deflecting objects that come into contact with it. Note that unless otherwise specified, reference numerals in FIGS. **36A-36C** refer to components that are the same as or generally similar to the components of FIGS. **28A** and **34A-35C**. FIGS. **36B** and **36C** further illustrate a crescent shaped non-return valve **1410** positioned adjacent a pump **1304**. In some embodiments, the inlet port **1432** of the non-return valve can be coupled to the pump outlet **1304b**.

(124) Further, although FIGS. **36B** and **36C** illustrate a non-return valve **1410** having a crescent shape with an upper curved surface which intersects a lower flat surface, any suitable crescent shape is appreciated. For example, in some embodiments, the lower flat surface can have a curve which conforms to the surface of a wound site. In such embodiments, the radius of curvature of the upper surface can be less than the radius of curvature of the lower surface so that the two surfaces intersect. In some embodiments, the housing of the non-return valve **1410** can be made of a rigid, semi-rigid, and/or flexible material. For example, in some embodiments, the upper and lower surfaces of the non-return valve can be semi-rigid. As another example, in some embodiments, the lower surface of the non-return valve **1410** can be less rigid than the upper surface so that the lower surface can better conform to the surface of a wound site. The non-return valve **1410** can be made from any suitable material. In addition, for non-return valve embodiments including a reed, the reed can have a curved portion that fits inside the crescent shape of the non-return valve **1410** housing to advantageously make the non-return valve **1410** more compact.

(125) Although not shown in FIGS. **34A-36C**, the non-return valve **1410** can be positioned between the wound contact layer and the cover layer such that a bottom surface of the non-return valve **1410** sits on the wound contact layer and a top surface of the non-return valve **1410** sits under the cover layer (e.g., wound contact layer **1310** and cover layer **1313** in FIG. **28A**). In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be sealed to the wound dressing **1302** and/or the exhaust system **1370** with an oil seal.

(126) FIG. **37** illustrates a crescent shaped non-return valve **1410** positioned superficially above an exhaust system **1370** and a wound dressing **1302**. As described above, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be integrated with the exhaust system **1370** and be positioned between the wound contact layer **1310** and the cover layer **1313**. In some embodiments, the inlet port **1432** of the non-return valve **1410** can be fluidically coupled to the outlet of the pump (not shown) and the outlet port **1436** of the non-return valve **1410** can be fluidically coupled to an inlet of the exhaust system **1370** (not shown). In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be integrated with the exhaust system **1370** beyond the border of the wound dressing **1302** (i.e., external to the wound dressing **1302**).

(127) FIGS. **38A-38E** illustrate various positions of a non-return valve **1410** in relation to a pump **1304** and an exhaust system **1370**. FIG. **38A** illustrates a non-return valve **1410** positioned between a pump **1304** and an exhaust system **1370**. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be fluidically coupled to an outlet of the pump **1304** and an inlet of the exhaust system **1370**. In some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be fluidically coupled to an outlet of the exhaust system (e.g., so that the exhaust system **1370** is interposed between the non-return valve **1410** and the pump **1304**). FIG. **38B** illustrates a non-return valve **1410** positioned after an exhaust system **1370**. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can

be fluidically coupled to an outlet of the exhaust system **1370**. FIG. **38C** illustrates a non-return valve **1410** positioned between an inlet (not labeled) and a pump **1304**. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be fluidically coupled to an inlet of the wound dressing and an inlet of the pump **1304**. As another example, FIG. **38C** illustrates a non-return valve **1410** integrated with an inlet of a pump **1304**. FIG. **38D** illustrates a non-return valve **1410** positioned after a pump **1304** and integrated with an outlet of an exhaust system **1370**. FIG. **38E** illustrates a non-return valve **1410** positioned after a pump **1304** and integrated with an inlet of an exhaust system **1370**. The non-return valves **1410** illustrated in FIGS. **38A-38E** are shown as having a rectangular shape with circular ends. However, it will be understood that the non-return valves **1410** in FIGS. **38A-38E** can have any suitable shape, such as, for example, a crescent shape, among any other suitable shape. The non-return valve **1410** and/or the exhaust system **1370** in FIGS. **38A, 38B, 38D, and 38E** can be wholly or partially positioned within or external to a dressing border (not shown). A portion of the non-return valve **1410** and/or the exhaust system **1370** in FIGS. **38A, 38B, 38D, and 38E** can be wholly or partially integrated within a wound dressing (not shown). In some embodiments, the pump inlet can include a fluid ingress inhibition component in fluid communication with the pump. The component can allow gas (e.g., air) but inhibit liquid (e.g., wound exudate) from passing through. The component can provide a plurality of flow paths between an interior of the wound dressing **1302** and the pump **1304** so that occlusion (e.g., from wound exudate) of the pump **1304** is inhibited. Examples of such applications where additional disclosure relating to the preceding may be found include U.S. Provisional Application No. 62/327,676, titled “Fluid Ingress Inhibition Component for Reduced Pressure Apparatuses,” filed on Apr. 26, 2016, the disclosure of which is hereby incorporated by reference in its entirety. (128) FIGS. **39A and 39B** illustrate two positions of a crescent-shaped non-return valve **1410** in relation to an exhaust system **1370**. FIG. **39A** illustrates a non-return valve **1410** having a crescent shape integrated with an exhaust system **1370**. For example, in some embodiments, the non-return valve **1410** can be fluidically coupled and integrated with an exhaust system **1370** somewhere between an inlet and an outlet of the exhaust system **1370**. FIG. **39B** illustrates a non-return valve **1410** having a crescent shape positioned after a pump (not shown) and integrated with an outlet of an exhaust system **1370**. For example, in some embodiments, the exhaust system **1370** can be fluidically coupled to an outlet **1304b** of the pump. The non-return valves **1410** illustrated in FIGS. **39A-39B** are shown as having a crescent shape. However, it will be understood that the non-return valves **1410** in FIGS. **39A-39B** can have any suitable shape, such as, for example, a rectangular shape with circular ends, among any other suitable shape.

(129) All of the features disclosed in this specification (including any accompanying exhibits, claims, abstract and drawings), and/or all of the steps of any method or process so disclosed, may be combined in any combination, except combinations where at least some of such features and/or steps are mutually exclusive. The disclosure is not restricted to the details of any foregoing embodiments. The disclosure extends to any novel one, or any novel combination, of the features disclosed in this specification (including any accompanying claims, abstract and drawings), or to any novel one, or any novel combination, of the steps of any method or process so disclosed.

(130) Various modifications to the implementations described in this disclosure may be readily apparent to those skilled in the art, and the generic principles defined herein may be applied to other implementations without departing from the spirit or scope of this disclosure. Thus, the disclosure is not intended to be limited to the implementations shown herein, but is to be accorded the widest scope consistent with the principles and features disclosed herein. Certain embodiments of the disclosure are encompassed in the claim set listed below or presented in the future.

Claims

1. A wound dressing apparatus comprising: a wound contact layer configured to be positioned in contact with a wound; a first area over the wound contact layer comprising: a lower spacer layer; an absorbent layer; a second area over the wound contact layer comprising a plurality of spacer layers and a negative pressure source and/or electronic components positioned within or between the plurality of spacer layers, wherein the first area is positioned adjacent to the second area and separated by a partition; an upper spacer layer configured to cover the first area and the second area and to allow air to be communicated between the first area and second area around the partition; and a cover layer configured to cover and form a seal over the wound contact layer, the upper spacer layer, the first area, and the second area.
 2. The wound dressing apparatus of claim 1, wherein the plurality of spacer layers in the second area comprise a third spacer layer beneath the negative pressure source and/or electronic components and a fourth spacer layer positioned above the negative pressure source and/or electronic components, wherein the fourth spacer layer comprises one or more cutouts or recesses configured to receive the negative pressure source and/or electronic components.
 3. The wound dressing apparatus of claim 1, wherein the partition comprises a non-porous dam.
 4. The wound dressing apparatus of claim 1, further comprising one or more user interface components configured to allow a user to operate the negative pressure source and/or electronic components.
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